CMA Standards of Conduct
for Members of Committees, Task Forces, and Volunteers

Non-profit committee/task force members should adhere to ethical standards of honesty, integrity, and confidentiality, and should prioritize the Association's mission above personal interests. They also have a legal duty to act with care, loyalty, and obedience.
More specifically:

1. Duty of Care

- **Stay Informed:** Be knowledgeable about the organization's mission, programs, policies, and operations.
- **Review Materials:** Carefully review agendas and supporting documents before meetings. If the materials that you've received are unclear or inconsistent with your understanding of the rules governing the board, please discuss your concerns with the members of committee or the board chair well in advance of the meting
- **Be Prepared:** Come to meetings with thoughtful questions and prepared to contribute.

2. Duty of Loyalty

- **Prioritize the Organization:** Place the interests of the nonprofit above personal interests or gain or interests of other committee or board members.
- **Avoid Conflicts:** Disclose and avoid existing or potential conflicts of interest.
- **Maintain Confidentiality:** Protect sensitive information and data obtained during committee/task force work. Do not forward/share email information without the approval of the sender.

3. Duty of Obedience:

- **Follow the Law:** Ensure the organization complies with all applicable laws and regulations. If you believe the organization is not in compliance, please raise your concerns with your committee/task force chair and/or the board president. You should expect a clear and coherent response to your concerns.

If you do not receive such response you are entitled to raise your concerns with the full board. Bear in mind, however, CMA is a complex institution. The president and board members spend enormous amounts of time administering CMA with almost no paid staff. Please refrain from raising minor issues with the board unless you understand them to be material or significant to the quiet enjoyment of our community.

- **Adhere to Bylaws:** Follow the organization's bylaws and governance documents. Do not exceed the authority given to you by CMA's bylaws and governance documents.
- **Uphold Mission:** Support the organization's mission and strategic goals.

4. Ethical Standards

- **Honesty and Integrity:** Demonstrate honesty and integrity in all activities.
- **Transparency:** Be open and transparent in communication and decision-making.
- **Respectful Conduct:** Maintain respectful and courteous behavior in all interactions, including board, committee, and task force meetings. Avoid "got you" questions and grandstanding. Remember, our job is to strengthen our community, not to divide it. If you don't feel comfortable with this mandate, perhaps committee, task force, or board service at CMA is not for you.

5. Other Important Considerations:

- **Professional Competence:** Conduct themselves with professional competence and efficiency.
- **Open Communication:** Encourage open communication and collaboration within the committee, task force, and with the board.
- **Seek Professional Development:** Strive for personal and professional growth and encourage the development of others.
- **Recognize Limits:** Understand the roles and responsibilities of staff and management, and refrain from micromanaging.
- **Engage with the Community:** Keep the community informed about issues affecting the organization.